

BUILDING PERMIT FEES:

Minnesota Building Permit Fees and Expenses, 2019

HOUSINGAFFORDABILITYINSTITUTE.ORG

DECEMBER 2020

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ABOUT THE HOUSING AFFORDABILITY INSTITUTE

Founded in 2018 by Housing First Minnesota, the Housing Affordability Institute is a nonprofit organization seeking to increase housing affordability and protect homeownership by producing industry-leading research on homeownership and the cost drivers behind our growing affordability challenges.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Governments in Minnesota are authorized by statute, with further guidance from the Minnesota Department of Labor and Industry, to charge fees for building inspection and plan review, with clear direction that these fees are limited to their direct and immediate costs.

Publicly available data reported by Minnesota municipalities reveals $42.5 million in excess net revenue for building permit fees in 2019. Although reporting compliance has significantly increased, it remains an issue for the Annual Reporting requirement. 2019 holds the second-highest compliance rate since the legislation was enacted, with 307 reports filed following several extensions granted by the Minnesota Department of Labor and Industry.

A review of Minnesota municipal building permit finances from 2014-2018 by the Housing Affordability Institute previously identified both recurrent building permit surpluses and a lack of reporting by municipalities. A deeper review of building permit finances for the 2019 report year reveals systemic flaws in building permit finances. A number of factors contribute to this broken system:

1. **Valuation-Based Fees.** Minnesota's system of valuation-based building permit fees is flawed and rewards municipalities to increase new-home valuation.
    - In 95% of the instances researched, cities increase the valuation of the project, which in turn increases building permit fees.
    - Fee structures across growing cities can vary widely, with a variance as high as 53% for the same project valuation.
2. **Report Format.** The Annual Report format is in need of improvement.
3. **Limited Authority.** Currently, the Department of Labor and Industry's authority is limited to collecting these reports. No state oversight exists to hold municipalities accountable.

The valuation-based permitting system currently used in Minnesota can act as an incentive for municipalities to increase valuations, which in turn increases building permit surpluses. Further, municipalities continue to be hesitant to file these reports as required by law.

NEW INFORMATION FOR 2020

More than **$42.5 million** in excess building permit fees reported for 2019.

95% of the time, home valuations are increased by the building official.

Building permit fees for the same home by the same builder can vary by as much as **$1,800** across the fastest-growing cities.

Some overhead calculations and accounting formulas indicate the surplus figures may be far higher.

Over-collected fees add **thousands of dollars** to new home prices.

As policymakers look to address the various inefficiencies in housing policies, this area presents a straight-forward and manageable solution: simple reforms with the potential to reduce new home prices by up to several thousand dollars per home. Without changes, property owners will continue to be unfairly overcharged for building inspections and plan review services, and home affordability will continue to be negatively impacted.

INTRODUCTION

Like its predecessor, *"Building Permit Fees: Boosting the Bottom Line for Minnesota Cities,"* this report provides a five-year review of Minnesota cities' building permit fees. These funds are collected to pay for the direct costs of plan review, building code compliance and safety inspections. This data is reported by municipalities via the Municipal Construction and Development Fee Revenue and Expenditures Annual Report (Annual Reports) requirement under Minnesota Statues 326B.145.

These Annual Reports filed by Minnesota municipalities cover several research-worthy topics such as park fees, impact fees and engineering costs. However, each category is separated by function, and plan review and building inspections revenue and expenses must stand on their own. The other data provided on the report, while important, have no bearing on or relationship to building permit and plan review costs studied in this paper.

Conflation of various reportable items on the Annual Report, which has been erroneously pushed by some civic authorities, does a tremendous disservice to appropriate public discourse by sowing confusion. Statute and agency guidance contemplate these subjects separately from each other, not as a general topic of "development" revenue and expenses as critics suggest. This report adheres to the same statutory structure and guidance, which is in line with legislative and agency intent.

To place a finer point, building permit and plan review fees are required by statute to be proportionate to the direct costs. There is no statutory basis to create surplus in inspections and plan review fees to offset other budget items within a city or in anticipation of a drop in permit and plan review revenue in some future economic downturn. It is clear from statute and Department of Labor and Industry guidance that permit revenues are to be in direct relationship with costs for that given year. For example, it is inappropriate to suggest that either revenues or expenses can be spread over a decade. That would entirely invalidate the concept of a specific fee to each homeowner for their specific plan review and inspection services.

The need for clarification underscores a key observation by the Housing Affordability Institute: As it stands today, the Annual Report format lacks key information and its layout invites confusion.

STATE GUIDANCE ON PERMIT COSTS & REVENUE

Official guidance from the State of Minnesota via its designated administrative authority clearly preempts any rationalization for over collecting building permit fees over time. This guidance does not allow municipalities to over collect building permit fees in 'good years' as a strategy to fund city overhead in an economic downturn.

The "fee for service" model is clear. Fees for building permits are prohibited from being used for the generation of general fund revenue. Further, the State of Minnesota's guidance provides clarity on the narrow, issue-specific use of these funds. Inspections and plan review dollars cannot be used to support other municipal projects or funds.

"Each municipality is to evaluate local costs associated with the enforcement of the code. **From this local evaluation, a fee structure can be established to cover associated and related code enforcement responsibilities.** Again, by Minnesota Rule, the fees are to be commensurate with the services required/ provided; building permit fees may not be used as a tool to raise additional monies for the municipalities' general fund…

…Ideally, when a citizen purchases a permit, it is considered a "fee for service" charge that should be set-up to balance out at zero. **Building permit applicants should not be charged additional or extra fees to support a municipalities' general fund or other special interest projects undertaken by the municipality."**

Source: Minnesota State Building Code, Code Adoption Guide, Minnesota Department of Labor and Industry Emphasis added.



BUILDING PERMIT SURPLUSES CONTINUE TO GROW

Although the statutory deadline for 2019 Annual Reports was on June 30, 2020, the Department of Labor and Industry allowed extensions to municipalities due to COVID-19. On Sept. 15, 2020, the Housing Affordability Institute obtained all 2019 data received by that date.

307	$42,567,636
FILED	EXCESS BUILDING PERMIT REVENUE

TOP 5 MUNICIPALITIES – 2019 NET SURPLUS REVENUE

1	City of Minneapolis	$12,962,457
2	City of Shakopee	$3,222,541
3	City of Woodbury	$2,670,823
4	City of Minnetonka	$1,842,831
5	City of Plymouth	$1,745,601

The complete 2019 data set is available in the appendix section.

REPORT COMPLIANCE: 2018 AND 2019

As of the same date a year ago, the number of municipalities filing their 2018 Annual Report was 377. A total of 104 municipalities reported not meeting the $5,000 reporting threshold in 2018, an increase of 40 municipalities over our earlier report. Data on municipalities not meeting the reporting threshold in previous years was not provided by the Department of Labor and Industry.

The gap between 2018's record 377 reports and 2019's 307 shows that compliance is again an issue. This includes several notable municipalities that enjoyed substantial residential construction for the 2018 report year:

- City of Elko New Market
- City of Jordan
- City of St. Paul
- Sherburne County

Note: Additional municipalities, such as the City of Corcoran, filed Annual Reports following the receipt of data on Sept. 15, 2020. Data submitted following Sept. 15 was not analyzed.

QUESTIONS REMAIN

With $42.5 million in building permit surpluses reported in 2019 alone, three questions come to mind:

Had municipalities fully complied with the Annual Report statute in 2019 and all previous years, how much would the actual reported surplus total be since the housing recovery? Short of an independent audit, we cannot accurately answer this question.

Given these massive reported surpluses, which government body is to provide oversight to ensure municipalities are required to comply with state rules?

The biggest question is what happens with all this surplus revenue, a question to which answers likely vary from municipality to municipality.

VALUATION-BASED BUILDING PERMITS

Valuation-based permitting is one issue identified as having contributed to the permit overcharge problem. Without such massive surpluses in building permit revenue, valuation-based building permit fees may not be an issue.

Under the Minnesota Building Administrative Code, Minn. Rules Chapter 1300.0160, building permit fees are, with some exceptions, to be based on the valuation of the project, as determined by the building official, with the permit applicants, often the homebuilder or remodeler, supplying the initial valuation.

With valuation-based building permit fees, two key factors present challenges: the fee schedules adopted by local governments, **and the building officials' ability to increase the reported valuation without any requirement for supporting rationale**. Together, these two factors have created a system in which more than $150 million in excess building permit revenue has been collected in recent years.

EXAMPLE

On typical new home projects, these *non-valuation* costs and variables can be 51% of final price point, or $190,000, for a $373,000 home.

MINN. RULES 1300.0160

Subp. 3: Building permit valuations. The applicant for a permit shall provide an estimated permit value at time of application. Permit valuations shall include total value of all construction work, including materials and labor, for which the permit is being issued, such as electrical, gas, mechanical, plumbing equipment, and permanent systems. Building permit valuation shall be set by the building official.

Exceptions: Building permit valuations for the following structures shall be based on the valuation of on-site work only:

A. manufactured homes containing a Housing and Urban Development (HUD) certification label;

B. prefabricated buildings with a Department of Labor and Industry prefabrication label; and

C. industrialized/modular buildings with an Industrialized Building Commission (IBC) label.

Subp. 4. Building permit fees. Building permit fees shall be based on valuation.

Exceptions:

A. one- and two-family dwelling maintenance permits for roofing, siding, windows, doors, or other minor projects may be charged a fixed fee;

B. permits for plumbing, mechanical, electrical, or other building service equipment systems may be based on valuation or charged a fixed fee.

SETTING PROJECT VALUATION

At first glance, the valuation of a project may sound like the final sales price of a new home or the total project cost of a remodel project. Under Minnesota Rules Chapter 1300.0160, Subd. 3, valuation is defined as the "*total value of all construction work, including materials and labor, for which the permit is being issued, such as electrical, gas, mechanical, plumbing equipment, and permanent systems.*"

Note that the sales price is NOT the figure to be used for valuation. In fact, under this guidance, the final lot price, landscaping, project overhead, and municipal or regional fees are not part of the project's valuation. Nor are appliances, or other non-permanent components. These exclusions, found in the state building code's administrative section, explain the difference between a home's final sales price and the permit valuation.

Today in Minnesota, it is the responsibility of the building official to determine the valuation of a project, based on information supplied by the building permit applicant.

VALUATION VARIANCES

In theory, a builder constructing the same home in different cities across Minnesota would see a consistent valuation, but a review of building permits for new homes built in Minnesota in 2019 reveals unexplainable differences.

Three Minnesota homebuilders supplied researchers with access to nearly 300 building permit applications from 2019 across nearly a dozen cities, enabling researchers to review valuation data. Researchers were able to assess the status of 290 of the 300 permit applications and homebuilder records demonstrated that local building officials increase the valuation of a new home at permitting some 95% of the time, with an average valuation increase of 26.6%.

- Permit Valuations Increased: 275 of 290 Times (94.83%)
- Permit Valuations Decreased: 2 of 290 Times (0.69%)
- Permit Valuations Unchanged: 13 of 290 Times (4.48%)
- **Average Submitted Valuation: $249,472.34**
- **Average Accepted Valuation: $318,603.44**
- **Average Increase: 26.71%**

Reviewing specific models by specific builders constructed in different cities across the Twin Cities metropolitan area, valuation for these homes, as determined by the building official, varied widely.

FEE SCHEDULE

Minnesota Statute 326B.153 provides a sample fee schedule, which is to be used as a basis for municipalities to establish a fee schedule that meets their local costs. This sample schedule breaks valuation into eight groupings: $1-$500, $501-$2,000, $2,001-$25,000, $25,001-$50,000, $50,000-$100,000, $100,001-$500,000, $500,001-$1,000,000, and $1,000,001 or greater. A typical new home built in Minnesota would be valued in the $100,001-$500,000 sample category.

Under this example, with a home valuation of $250,000, the permit and plan review fee would be **$3,628.60**.

$1,186.65 + ($6.75*250,000-$100,000)/1000) = $2,199.15
Plus, Plan Review 65% of Permit Fee = $1,429.45

Total Permit Fee, Less State Surcharge and Other Additional Fees Collected at Permitting: **$3,628.60**

MINN. STATE STATUTE 326B.153

Subd. 1 B(6): $100,001 to $500,000, $1,186.65 for the first $100,000 plus $6.75 for each additional $1,000 or fraction thereof, to and including $500,000;

VALUATION AND FEE SCHEDULES

As noted, municipalities must adopt their own building permit fee schedules. Using a base value of $250,000, the nearest round figure to the average valuation of permits reviewed, it is easy to see how permit fees vary across the Twin Cities.

PERMIT FEES, $250,000 VALUATION

A basic valuation of $250,000 can have a building permit and plan review fee ranging from a low of $3,228.64 in Lakeville to a high of $4,950.01 in Shakopee, with the same set of services provided.

LAKEVILLE	SHAKOPEE
Value: $250,000	Value: $250,000
Permit Fee: $1,956.75	Permit Fee: $3,000.01
Plan Review Fee: $1,271.89	Plan Review Fee: $1,950.00
Total: $3,228.64	**Total: $4,950.01**

Based off 2019 Fee Schedule as Adopted by Municipality

QUESTIONS REMAIN

Reviewing valuation and fee schedules yielded several questions, including:

Why do building officials routinely change valuation?

Why do valuations of the same home constructed by the same builder vary so widely from city to city?

Is there a more equitable and transparent way of setting building permit fees?

REPORT FORMAT

At first glance, the Annual Report format, which has been unchanged since its inception more than two decades ago, seems to provide a comprehensive look at annual development financing at the municipal level. In reality, the items included represent only a partial view of the topic. There are several notable omissions on the report and two questions emerge:

Can the report be modified to provide a more accurate look at development-related finances?

How can proportionality be established if a municipality's costs for each permit and permit classification are not known and tracked?

SECTION 1

MUNICIPALITY

While this is the most complete section, as presented, there is one improvement to be made here: adding a section to affirm that the reporting threshold was not met. Currently, when a municipality does not file an Annual Report, it is assumed it did not reach the $5,000 filing threshold.

Section I Suggested Improvement:

Add a checkbox for municipalities to affirm that they did not reach the $5,000 filing threshold and require all municipalities to file the report.



SECTION 2 AND 3

BUILDING INSPECTION PERMITS AND SECTION III. FEE REVENUE AND EXPENSES ASSOCIATED WITH BUILDING PERMITS AND INSPECTIONS

In its current form, these two sections tell two different stories. Section II outlines permit figures and valuation for the following classifications: New Single-Family, New Multifamily, Commercial/Industrial/Institutional, Renovations (all types) and the catch-all of "other", which includes window, door, deck permits, etc., that do not fall under renovation activities.

Section III then provides a high-level accounting of building permit finances for permits, plan review and "other" sources, as well as an undefined expense figure. For expenses, this section includes a single line. As noted previously, the current format allows municipalities to include both direct and indirect spending as a single item with no additional guidance on what is acceptable to include as overhead.

Expenses and income, under Section III, are reported in aggregate and not by the permit classification level. Therefore, it is not possible to study only residential building permits, nor is it possible to see which permit types are driving any reported surpluses or deficits.

Section II and III Suggested Improvements:

Combine these two sections into one larger section that provides a more detailed look including:

- List income and direct expenses by permit classification (including plan review).
- Explicitly state overhead and direct spending as two separate items.

SECTION 4 AND 5

These sections do not include building permit-related data and as such have not been reviewed or analyzed by the Housing Affordability Institute. These sections contain several research-worthy topics for future study.

REPORTING, BUT NOT OVERSIGHT

The review of permit finances undertaken in *"Building Permit Fees: Boosting the Bottom Line for Minnesota Cities"* was the first published analysis of the data in the 13-year history of the reporting records.

While the Minnesota Department of Labor and Industry serves as the designated agency to collect this information via the Annual Reports under Minnesota State Statute 326B.145, the Department is not charged with reviewing or analyzing the data. In fact, regrettably, no entity in the state has the express authority to proactively review or analyze this information or engage in any enforcement with regard to overcollection of building permit fees.

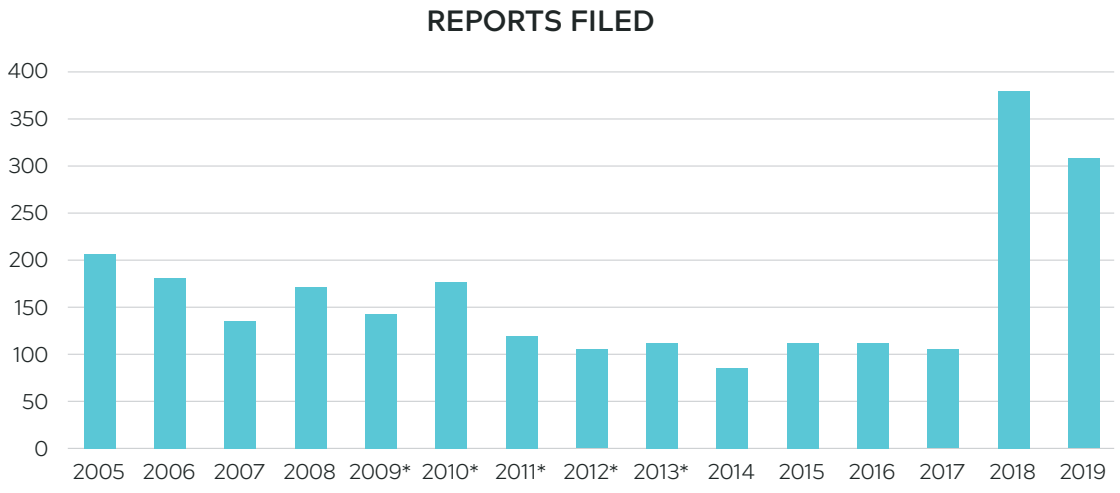
The Department of Labor and Industry does, however, have the authority to encourage and compel municipalities to file reports, which explains the massive increase in filing in the two most recent years.

REPORT COMPLIANCE

Since its inception in 2005, compliance with the report has typically been weak. In the 2018 Report Year which achieved 377 total reports, the Housing Affordability Institute expressed strong interest in the reporting results. Prior to that, few years reached more than 200 reports filed.

What action can be taken to ensure greater compliance with the Annual Report requirement?

Who will hold municipalities accountable to ensure a fair and reasonable building permit fee process is properly followed and what enforcement powers will this oversight include?



** During these years, the reporting threshold was increased by the Minnesota Legislature to $10,000 annually.*

CONCLUSION

As more data has emerged, a clearer picture is presented of the practice of collecting building permit revenue that routinely and substantially exceeds fee-for-service expenses. Despite concerns being raised last year, municipalities continue to over collect building permit revenue. Troublingly, more evidence of the creation of special municipal accounts for these funds has emerged. This new information has also raised more questions for policymakers to consider as they address this topic.

ISSUE 1

EXCESS BUILDING PERMIT REVENUE

This deep analysis of revenue against expenses indicates that cities are collectively generating literally millions of dollars in excess building permit revenue, when in fact, state statute and department guidance require a legitimate fee for a service provided. This raises three key questions:

Why do municipalities continue to build massive budget surpluses of building permit revenue?

How are municipalities using this excess building permit revenue?

What happens with all this surplus revenue?

ISSUE 2

VALUATION-BASED PERMITTING

Valuation-based permitting as required by law has led property owners of all types to overpay for building permits by millions of dollars over the past five years. An in-depth review of municipal fee schedules, building permit applications and final issued permits reveals that two factors are at play. 95% of the time, the valuation of new homes is increased by the local building official. This change increases building permit fees. Aside from routine permit valuation changes, base building permit fees vary widely.

Why do building officials routinely change valuation?

Why do valuations from the same home and the same builder vary so widely from city to city?

Is there a more equitable and transparent way of setting building permit fees?

ISSUE 3

ANNUAL REPORT FORMAT

The current format of the Annual Report is somewhat limited. Building permit finances for residential projects cannot be examined under the current reporting format. Further, municipalities do not currently track plan review and inspection costs at either the per-permit or per-classification level. This lack of detail also adds to questions about proportionality.

Can the report be modified to provide a full look at development-related finances?

How can proportionality be established if a municipality's costs for each building permit and permit classification are not known and tracked?

ISSUE 4

LIMITED AUTHORITY

While the Minnesota Department of Labor and Industry is charged with serving as the collector and repository of Municipal Construction and Development Fee Revenue and Expenses Annual Reports, the Department's role ends there. There is no agency or state official charged with reviewing or analyzing the data, assessing the information and engaging in oversight to ensure Minnesota's homebuyers are in fact paying an appropriate fee for service. At present, there is no recourse for those who have been overcharged by municipalities. With no oversight, overcollection of building permit funds will only continue.

Who will hold municipalities accountable to ensure a fair and reasonable building permit fee process is properly followed and what enforcement powers will this oversight include?

What action can be taken to ensure greater compliance with the Annual Report requirement?

With these questions answered, the underlying issues of building permit overcollections can be addressed, and safeguards put into place. Then, a new method of establishing building permit fees can be considered.

NOTES

Erickson, Nicholas. *Building Permits: Boosting the Bottom Line for Minnesota Cities*. Housing Affordability Institute. August 2019.

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Minnesota Department of Labor and Industry. Reported Municipal Construction and Development Fee Revenue and Expenses Annual Report Data, 2015-2018 Report Years. Provided July 17, 2019.

Minnesota Department of Labor and Industry. Reported Municipal Construction and Development Fee Revenue and Expenses Annual Report Data, 2018 Report Year, Updated. Provided September 15, 2019.

Minnesota Construction Codes and Licensing Division. "Minnesota State Building Code, Code Adoption Guide." Minnesota Department of Labor and Industry. Jan. 14, 2016.

Office of the Revisor of Statutes. "Minnesota State Statutes, Chapter 326B, Section 153." Minnesota State Legislature. July 1, 2019.

All other data was provided by the named entity in response to correspondence from the research team.

APPENDIX

Figure A-1: 2019 Municipal Construction and Development Fee Revenue and Expenses Annual Report Data

MUNICIPALITY	PERMIT FEE REVENUE	PLAN REVIEW FEES	OTHER FEES	TOTAL FEE REVENUE	BUILDING INSPECTION EXPENSES	TOTAL LESS EXPENSE
2019						
Arthur Township	6,700	3,066	203	***9,969***	7,550	**2,419**
Baytown Township	53,877	29,184	2,100	***85,161***	56,036	**29,125**
Becker Township	94,435	35,899	0	***130,334***	51,266	**79,068**
Benton County	161,286	79,543	25,264	***266,093***	48,769	**217,324**
Carver County	190,489	97,525	5,868	***293,882***	400,902	**(107,020)**
Cascade Township	24,316	12,401	0	***36,717***	19,685	**17,032**
Chengwatana Township	7,609	4,946	524	***13,079***	10,797	**2,282**
Chisago County	393,382	213,929	103,701	***711,012***	692,549	**18,463**
City of Albany	40,306	10,564	3,823	***54,693***	49,002	**5,691**
City of Albertville	114,856	63,115	89,678	***267,649***	196,441	**71,208**
City of Alexandria	390,338	114,533	43,059	***547,930***	421,566	**126,364**
City of Andover	757,603	242,501	0	***1,000,104***	933,909	**66,195**
City of Annandale	38,679	22,118	9,991	***70,788***	63,251	**7,537**
City of Anoka	225,002	56,400	3,340	***284,742***	178,571	**106,171**
City of Apple Valley	615,380	250,405	248,030	***1,113,815***	1,683,128	**(569,313)**
City of Arden Hills	310,505	184,608	315,664	***810,777***	408,724	**402,053**
City of Avon	68,456	20,513	0	***88,969***	63,177	**25,792**
City of Baxter	227,372	113,591	77,014	***417,977***	247,855	**170,122**
City of Becker	114,878	70,519	200,489	***385,886***	157,458	**228,428**
City of Belle Plaine	59,759	29,450	16,999	***106,208***	175,771	**(69,563)**
City of Bemidji	194,162	70,894	207,335	***472,391***	532,223	**(59,832)**
City of Big Lake	311,776	112,204	50,825	***474,805***	429,040	**45,765**
City of Birchwood Villge	9,235	2,810	0	***12,045***	6,926	**5,119**
City of Bird Island	4,333	0	0	***4,333***	3,850	**483**
City of Biwabik	17,659	9,227	0	***26,886***	17,054	**9,832**
City of Blooming Prairie	9,216	4,455	158	***13,829***	11,259	**2,570**
City of Bloomington	1,764,477	707,708	1,840,953	***4,313,138***	3,018,234	**1,294,904**
City of Braham	41,629	9,326	2,391	***53,346***	52,786	**560**
City of Breckenridge	11,317	0	0	***11,317***	101,201	**(89,884)**
City of Brooklyn Park	2,211,578	43,069	3,450	***2,258,097***	2,307,036	**(48,939)**
City of Buffalo	289,838	171,515	105,358	***566,711***	314,414	**252,297**
City of Burnsville	1,061,135	498,012	1,075,770	***2,634,917***	1,328,450	**1,306,467**
City of Byron	115,326	31,639	21,021	***167,986***	70,304	**97,682**
City of Cambridge	242,615	0	45,611	***288,226***	438,113	**(149,887)**
City of Cannon Falls	48,021	18,351	2,220	***68,592***	38,417	**30,175**
City of Carlton	17,923	9,223	0	***27,146***	25,345	**1,801**
City of Carver	478,280	221,264	10,001	***709,545***	611,728	**97,817**
City of Centerville	77,059	40,547	4,904	***122,510***	146,268	**(23,758)**
City of Champlin	171,863	56,863	99,982	***328,708***	318,422	**10,286**
City of Chanhassen	646,355	324,962	303,883	***1,275,200***	1,207,669	**67,531**
City of Chaska	366,547	165,379	165,284	***697,210***	1,114,425	**(417,215)**
City of Chatfield	18,011	6,480	2,346	***26,837***	77,054	**(50,217)**
City of Chisholm	21,242	0	0	***21,242***	42,400	**(21,158)**
City of Circle Pines	68,537	8,294	15,992	***92,823***	45,955	**46,868**
City of Claremont	5,466	2,697	1,111	***9,274***	5,206	**4,068**
City of Clear Lake **	1,239,949	0	0	***1,239,949***	18,446	**1,221,503**
City of Clearwater	63,308	39,327	85,487	***188,122***	29,468	**158,654**
City of Cleveland	63,564	18,727	0	***82,291***	55,274	**27,017**

MUNICIPALITY	PERMIT FEE REVENUE	PLAN REVIEW FEES	OTHER FEES	TOTAL FEE REVENUE	BUILDING INSPECTION EXPENSES	TOTAL LESS EXPENSE
City of Cloquet	138,143	30,077	6,423	***174,643***	119,066	**55,577**
City of Cold Spring	37,374	18,451	74,268	***130,093***	111,092	**19,001**
City of Cologne	62,073	42,788	11,790	***116,651***	38,197	**78,454**
City of Columbia Hghts.	137,542	41,043	52,047	***230,632***	375,981	**(145,349)**
City of Comfrey	0	0	0	***0***	0	**0**
City of Coon Rapids	1,089,769	321,763	466,975	***1,878,507***	1,483,156	**395,351**
City of Cosmos	7,731	940	0	***8,671***	0	**8,671**
City of Cottage Grove	1,205,461	478,484	325,384	***2,009,329***	754,592	**1,254,737**
City of Courtland	10,111	200	1,412	***11,723***	0	**11,723**
City of Crookston	44,371	6,350	3,731	***54,452***	98,203	**(43,751)**
City of Crosby	101,237	35,017	6,263	***142,517***	75,571	**66,946**
City of Crystal	248,770	95,242	0	***344,012***	330,938	**13,074**
City of Darwin	0	0	0	***0***	0	**0**
City of Dassel	9,732	5,547	0	***15,279***	0	**15,279**
City of Dayton	962,261	516,440	25,910	***1,504,611***	550,123	**954,488**
City of Deephaven	125,791	65,213	52,015	***243,019***	312,879	**(69,860)**
City of Deerwood	6,252	3,411	142	***9,805***	9,038	**767**
City of Delano	211,703	104,686	20,860	***337,249***	227,656	**109,593**
City of Dellwood	18,214	6,833	4,500	***29,547***	57,315	**(27,768)**
City of Detroit Lakes	282,680	86,292	0	***368,972***	309,965	**59,007**
City of Dilworth	23,601	785	7,442	***31,828***	43,336	**(11,508)**
City of Dodge Center	36,715	0	0	***36,715***	39,888	**(3,173)**
City of Duluth	2,651,328	685,551	0	***3,336,879***	2,020,351	**1,316,528**
City of Dundas	31,165	15,527	1,289	***47,981***	27,932	**20,049**
City of Eagan	1,407,511	782,029	507,121	***2,696,661***	2,625,073	**71,588**
City of Eagle Lake	27,206	12,898	3,939	***44,043***	31,083	**12,960**
City of East Bethel	279,959	65,471	0	***345,430***	319,615	**25,815**
City of Eden Prairie	1,822,372	793,385	670,585	***3,286,342***	2,059,568	**1,226,774**
City of Edina	2,038,274	1,029,626	1,019,013	***4,086,913***	3,426,668	**660,245**
City of Elk River	457,246	223,094	148,119	***828,459***	2,225,835	**(1,397,376)**
City of Ely	53,400	11,800	13,900	***79,100***	92,100	**(13,000)**
City of Elysian	36,813	20,253	5,950	***63,016***	36,030	**26,986**
City of Excelsior	175,401	83,353	0	***258,754***	40,713	**218,041**
City of Fairfax	5,872	0	0	***5,872***	6,370	**(498)**
City of Fairmont	17,200	28,334	0	***45,534***	0	**45,534**
City of Falcon Heights	101,441	38,783	6,535	***146,759***	96,145	**50,614**
City of Faribault	272,520	121,743	105,575	***499,838***	478,937	**20,901**
City of Farmington	297,890	71,270	0	***369,160***	412,357	**(43,197)**
City of Fergus Falls	122,098	0	26,915	***149,013***	105,908	**43,105**
City of Foley	61,801	0	0	***61,801***	52,801	**9,000**
City of Forest Lake	533,485	227,718	0	***761,203***	591,201	**170,002**
City of Frazee	8,121	973	0	***9,094***	4,060	**5,034**
City of Freeport	2,839	0	0	***2,839***	2,414	**425**
City of Fridley	490,491	228,558	199,579	***918,628***	577,600	**341,028**
City of Gem Lake	80,090	17,614	0	***97,704***	23,452	**74,252**
City of Ghent	3,454	439	0	***3,893***	4,493	**(600)**
City of Glencoe	180,696	100,754	2,475	***283,925***	221,159	**62,766**
City of Glenwood	21,580	2,880	0	***24,460***	21,312	**3,148**
City of Golden Valley	584,847	250,649	597,899	***1,433,395***	1,216,889	**216,506**
City of Grand Rapids	344,252	104,765	199	***449,216***	676,545	**(227,329)**
City of Grant	105,755	52,877	0	***158,632***	39,444	**119,188**
City of Greenwood	32,358	15,342	12,628	***60,328***	51,719	**8,609**
City of Grove City	0	0	0	***0***	0	**0**

MUNICIPALITY	PERMIT FEE REVENUE	PLAN REVIEW FEES	OTHER FEES	TOTAL FEE REVENUE	BUILDING INSPECTION EXPENSES	TOTAL LESS EXPENSE
City of Ham Lake	220,641	98,155	91,497	***410,293***	424,716	**(14,423)**
City of Hamburg	9,425	4,926	1,357	***15,708***	11,332	**4,376**
City of Hanover	58,288	34,300	151,295	***243,883***	42,662	**201,221**
City of Harmony	0	0	0	***0***	0	**0**
City of Hastings	569,117	40,409	0	***609,526***	623,418	**(13,892)**
City of Hayfield	2,540	1,315	0	***3,855***	4,125	**(270)**
City of Hermantown	55,980	27,708	0	***83,688***	152,348	**(68,660)**
City of Hibbing	47,937	25,559	0	***73,496***	150,000	**(76,504)**
City of Hilltop	13,136	2,401	0	***15,537***	1,200	**14,337**
City of Hinckley	22,188	8,539	2,225	***32,952***	29,567	**3,385**
City of Hopkins	585,338	165,548	2,344	***753,230***	487,382	**265,848**
City of Hugo	306,645	116,460	76,572	***499,677***	614,407	**(114,730)**
City of Hutchinson	441,036	17,912	23,619	***482,567***	329,255	**153,312**
City of Independence	207,035	36,601	180	***243,816***	10,229	**233,587**
City of Inver Grove Heights	1,003,387	406,126	290,914	***1,700,427***	1,242,794	**457,633**
City of Isanti	174,440	97,651	50,002	***322,093***	351,585	**(29,492)**
City of Jackson	22,890	4,747	1,553	***29,190***	14,737	**14,453**
City of Kasson	176,734	41,888	22,538	***241,160***	110,257	**130,903**
City of La Prairie	5,362	2,568	40	***7,970***	31,647	**(23,677)**
City of La Crescent	27,088	9,214	5,293	***41,595***	45,529	**(3,934)**
City of Lake Crystal	22,336	5,508	1,568	***29,412***	27,022	**2,390**
City of Lake Elmo	780,104	460,523	192,388	***1,433,015***	468,607	**964,408**
City of Lakefield	710	0	0	***710***	0	**710**
City of Lakeland Shores	10,557	5,011	0	***15,568***	10,844	**4,724**
City of Lakeville	2,052,678	720,265	728,699	***3,501,642***	2,218,513	**1,283,129**
City of Lauderdale	24,420	9,193	4,940	***38,553***	41,536	**(2,983)**
City of Lester Prairie	19,123	9,891	1,541	***30,555***	21,092	**9,463**
City of Le Sueur	58,213	16,023	0	***74,236***	112,458	**(38,222)**
City of Lexington	18,560	59,032	86,006	***163,598***	174,789	**(11,191)**
City of Lindstrom	15,157	0	0	***15,157***	14,014	**1,143**
City of Lino Lakes	412,691	198,309	183,371	***794,371***	605,787	**188,584**
City of Litchfield	128,756	0	0	***128,756***	0	**128,756**
City of Little Canada	201,477	77,403	132,455	***411,335***	324,747	**86,588**
City of Long Lake	50,919	28,958	13,197	***93,074***	41,291	**51,783**
City of Long Prairie	36,958	0	0	***36,958***	29,092	**7,866**
City of Lonsdale	124,089	72,729	0	***196,818***	184,083	**12,735**
City of Loretto	8,057	3,065	570	***11,692***	5,517	**6,175**
City of Luverne	59,479	0	12,220	***71,699***	98,882	**(27,183)**
City of Madison Lake	13,757	5,864	12,868	***32,489***	22,590	**9,899**
City of Mahtomedi	254,516	75,978	0	***330,494***	380,513	**(50,019)**
City of Mankato	760,228	342,802	0	***1,103,030***	1,280,735	**(177,705)**
City of Mantorville	20,882	0	0	***20,882***	11,465	**9,417**
City of Maple Grove	1,736,487	921,337	1,169,188	***3,827,012***	3,995,749	**(168,737)**
City of Maple Lake	21,484	13,082	17,894	***52,460***	35,111	**17,349**
City of Maplewood	556,722	233,038	371,044	***1,160,804***	1,374,700	**(213,896)**
City of Marshall	216,249	62,496	6,447	***285,192***	502,094	**(216,902)**
City of Mayer	52,380	28,592	17,165	***98,137***	44,876	**53,261**
City of Medford	2,331	0	0	***2,331***	0	**2,331**
City of Medicine Lake	6,743	100	5,103	***11,946***	15,878	**(3,932)**
City of Medina	318,136	184,713	63,472	***566,321***	573,166	**(6,845)**
City of Melrose	50,479	14,913	19,150	***84,542***	71,918	**12,624**
City of Mendota Heights	258,462	66,322	82,731	***407,515***	281,496	**126,019**
City of Milaca	43,917	16,732	4,397	***65,046***	47,911	**17,135**

MUNICIPALITY	PERMIT FEE REVENUE	PLAN REVIEW FEES	OTHER FEES	TOTAL FEE REVENUE	BUILDING INSPECTION EXPENSES	TOTAL LESS EXPENSE
City of Minneapolis	15,454,850	5,185,752	9,275,815	***29,916,417***	16,953,960	**12,962,457**
City of Minnetonka	2,590,659	9,723	1,738,896	***4,339,278***	2,496,447	**1,842,831**
City of Minnetonka Beach	45,811	26,232	8,294	***80,337***	58,897	**21,440**
City of Minnetrista	607,846	309,210	0	***917,056***	364,273	**552,783**
City of Montevideo	43,996	16,142	3,748	***63,886***	120,742	**(56,856)**
City of Montgomery	43,097	19,588	140,000	***202,685***	51,558	**151,127**
City of Monticello	392,140	129,090	60,536	***581,766***	324,072	**257,694**
City of Montrose	79,459	44,869	8,635	***132,963***	66,482	**66,481**
City of Moorhead	462,091	60,169	40,128	***562,388***	599,789	**(37,401)**
City of Moose Lake	18,966	7,764	1,243	***27,973***	25,650	**2,323**
City of Mora	63,991	23,333	90	***87,414***	92,059	**(4,645)**
City of Morris	37,458	11,073	2,750	***51,281***	35,000	**16,281**
City of Mound	153,506	73,886	36,240	***263,632***	431,051	**(167,419)**
City of Mounds View	140,854	53,843	0	***194,697***	295,584	**(100,887)**
City of Mountain Iron	12,849	7,187	0	***20,036***	1,075	**18,961**
City of Mountain Lake	10,108	0	0	***10,108***	5,158	**4,950**
City of New Brighton	347,021	123,144	82,545	***552,710***	531,562	**21,148**
City of New Hope	150,228	67,813	234,226	***452,267***	657,130	**(204,863)**
City of New London	30,570	447	1,849	***32,866***	38,025	**(5,159)**
City of New Prague	94,003	49,174	159,645	***302,822***	259,948	**42,874**
City of New Ulm	200,297	96,392	9,099	***305,788***	280,780	**25,008**
City of Newport	813,594	122,413	12,074	***948,081***	236,139	**711,942**
City of North Branch	204,588	89,769	45,648	***340,005***	457,203	**(117,198)**
City of North Mankato	252,661	22,536	9,793	***284,990***	407,264	**(122,274)**
City of North St. Paul	347,432	134,774	0	***482,206***	41,566	**440,640**
City of Northfield	238,037	106,221	94,038	***438,296***	569,822	**(131,526)**
City of Nowthen	104,894	43,996	756	***149,646***	124,211	**25,435**
City of Oak Park Heights	60,937	17,007	1,230	***79,174***	231,464	**(152,290)**
City of Oakdale	432,746	101,196	134,837	***668,779***	430,215	**238,564**
City of Ogilvie	1,910	0	0	***1,910***	0	**1,910**
City of Olivia	9,719	28,411	1,577	***39,707***	5,400	**34,307**
City of Oronoco	21,070	7,995	2,282	***31,347***	21,052	**10,295**
City of Otsego	938,924	380,546	214,980	***1,534,450***	459,048	**1,075,402**
City of Owatonna	303,279	157,301	1,020	***461,600***	490,721	**(29,121)**
City of Paynesville	23,825	1,501	0	***25,326***	38,104	**(12,778)**
City of Perham	66,766	21,518	0	***88,284***	45,729	**42,555**
City of Pierz	18,387	8,859	4,054	***31,300***	45,865	**(14,565)**
City of Pillager	8,583	5,229	1,682	***15,494***	13,944	**1,550**
City of Pine Island	25,995	8,681	3,486	***38,162***	8,681	**29,481**
City of Pipestone	19,237	0	1,725	***20,962***	89,452	**(68,490)**
City of Plato	8,371	4,813	10	***13,194***	10,534	**2,660**
City of Plymouth	2,186,152	1,026,916	1,229,873	***4,442,941***	2,697,340	**1,745,601**
City of Princeton	81,958	43,260	0	***125,218***	31,962	**93,256**
City of Prior Lake	746,713	382,837	149,838	***1,279,388***	1,022,005	**257,383**
City of Proctor	10,531	1,500	0	***12,031***	9,685	**2,346**
City of Ramsey	577,644	241,565	222,143	***1,041,352***	1,642,072	**(600,720)**
City of Red Wing	251,634	80,872	49,701	***382,207***	421,878	**(39,671)**
City of Redwood Falls	163,988	79,387	100	***243,475***	97,009	**146,466**
City of Rice	31,568	20,438	6,631	***58,637***	50,809	**7,828**
City of Rice Lake	34,146	0	0	***34,146***	33,590	**556**
City of Richfield	724,223	390,307	600,389	***1,714,919***	1,294,134	**420,785**
City of Robbinsdale	215,247	97,483	80,841	***393,571***	296,720	**96,851**
City of Rochester	1,648,123	883,316	1,574,077	***4,105,516***	4,998,611	**(893,095)**

MUNICIPALITY	PERMIT FEE REVENUE	PLAN REVIEW FEES	OTHER FEES	TOTAL FEE REVENUE	BUILDING INSPECTION EXPENSES	TOTAL LESS EXPENSE
City of Rock Creek	8,126	5,044	0	***13,170***	11,138	**2,032**
City of Rogers	683,093	473,533	227,346	***1,383,972***	1,055,339	**328,633**
City of Rollingstone	2,194	1,123	251	***3,568***	4,691	**(1,123)**
City of Roseau	15,203	4,301	0	***19,504***	19,660	**(156)**
City of Rosemount	685,535	227,630	269,786	***1,182,951***	922,719	**260,232**
City of Roseville	1,287,650	582,532	566,315	***2,436,497***	842,995	**1,593,502**
City of Rush City **	0	0	13,428	***13,428***	10,071	**3,357**
City of Rushford	5,495	2,498	98	***8,091***	0	**8,091**
City of Sandstone	15,667	4,933	1,053	***21,653***	21,491	**162**
City of Sartell	183,643	76,573	119,620	***379,836***	611,234	**(231,398)**
City of Sauk Centre	48,358	10,970	0	***59,328***	43,461	**15,867**
City of Sauk Rapids	197,911	102,588	61,480	***361,979***	325,747	**36,232**
City of Savage	1,039,603	475,649	243,309	***1,758,561***	1,543,514	**215,047**
City of Shafer	25,185	12,308	225	***37,718***	27,964	**9,754**
City of Shakopee	1,762,337	969,580	1,577,185	***4,309,102***	1,086,561	**3,222,541**
City of Shoreview	770,399	189,698	222,069	***1,182,166***	1,114,102	**68,064**
City of Shorewood	348,626	130,579	11,045	***490,250***	243,911	**246,339**
City of Silver Bay	9,565	4,982	100	***14,647***	5,230	**9,417**
City of Silver Lake	8,249	3,764	567	***12,580***	11,731	**849**
City of South St. Paul	129,879	41,848	125,334	***297,061***	378,006	**(80,945)**
City of Spicer	14,075	2,126	862	***17,063***	14,209	**2,854**
City of Spring Lake Pk.	141,590	79,463	30,979	***252,032***	297,148	**(45,116)**
City of St. Anthony	92,355	33,048	56,927	***182,330***	250,971	**(68,641)**
City of St. Bonifacius	14,209	5,740	4,434	***24,383***	6,200	**18,183**
City of St. Charles	24,607	17,941	27,180	***69,728***	25,510	**44,218**
City of St. Cloud	653,056	249,508	308,996	***1,211,560***	1,644,258	**(432,698)**
City of St. Francis	376,034	214,955	35,185	***626,174***	621,683	**4,491**
City of St. Louis Park	1,592,755	1,112,910	1,232,094	***3,937,759***	2,880,662	**1,057,097**
City of St. Marys Point	3,095	2,161	882	***6,138***	2,164	**3,974**
City of St. Michael	539,529	244,929	4,105	***788,563***	735,561	**53,002**
City of St. Peter	68,391	21,087	55,440	***144,918***	244,763	**(99,845)**
City of Stacy	43,941	19,306	100	***63,347***	63,782	**(435)**
City of Staples	56,835	22,558	0	***79,393***	78,855	**538**
City of Stephen	195	0	0	***195***	0	**195**
City of Stewart	4,414	2,296	720	***7,430***	1,625	**5,805**
City of Stillwater	370,218	180,298	56,976	***607,492***	838,140	**(230,648)**
City of Thief River Falls	39,310	18,346	0	***57,656***	145,884	**(88,228)**
City of Tracy	21,435	1,925	85	***23,445***	45,218	**(21,773)**
City of Truman	5,713	0	0	***5,713***	3,500	**2,213**
City of Two Harbors	54,307	0	0	***54,307***	12,480	**41,827**
City of Victoria	506,464	346,523	89,773	***942,760***	453,034	**489,726**
City of Virginia	76,497	27,248	0	***103,745***	155,000	**(51,255)**
City of Waconia	392,321	204,805	76,547	***673,673***	399,255	**274,418**
City of Waite Park	59,404	38,545	24,222	***122,171***	271,215	**(149,044)**
City of Walker	19,965	4,429	0	***24,394***	50,597	**(26,203)**
City of Wanamingo	20,223	7,818	0	***28,041***	28,041	**0**
City of Watertown	138,476	34,053	14,976	***187,505***	80,775	**106,730**
City of Waverly	52,188	25,978	7,619	***85,785***	57,569	**28,216**
City of Wayzata	300,491	145,083	134,242	***579,816***	423,675	**156,141**
City of Wells	4,103	1,605	0	***5,708***	14,970	**(9,262)**
City of West St. Paul	461,890	66,106	671	***528,667***	427,817	**100,850**
City of White Bear Lake	398,272	140,936	174,024	***713,232***	794,153	**(80,921)**
City of Windom	57,964	15,238	0	***73,202***	72,979	**223**

MUNICIPALITY	PERMIT FEE REVENUE	PLAN REVIEW FEES	OTHER FEES	TOTAL FEE REVENUE	BUILDING INSPECTION EXPENSES	TOTAL LESS EXPENSE
City of Winona	717,725	0	0	***717,725***	559,332	**158,393**
City of Woodbury	2,538,110	1,026,460	917,769	***4,482,339***	1,811,516	**2,670,823**
City of Woodland	37,753	21,098	35,819	***94,670***	102,376	**(7,706)**
City of Wyoming	153,902	80,470	39,702	***274,074***	172,820	**101,254**
City of Zimmerman	148,493	71,630	31,212	***251,335***	85,622	**165,713**
Corinna Township	77,160	43,817	0	***120,977***	92,192	**28,785**
Denmark Township	43,421	20,806	15,429	***79,656***	22,621	**57,035**
Dover Township	2,550	1,658	0	***4,208***	2,206	**2,002**
Elmira Township	2,412	1,666	0	***4,078***	1,622	**2,456**
Empire Township	118,788	69,521	6,041	***194,350***	89,091	**105,259**
Eureka Township	11,686	7,417	8,498	***27,601***	27,902	**(301)**
Freeborn County	41,770	23,888	3,760	***69,418***	104,359	**(34,941)**
Goodhue County	240,777	106,455	0	***347,232***	373,906	**(26,674)**
Haverhill Township	13,555	8,810	0	***22,365***	9,886	**12,479**
High Forest Township	11,540	7,509	0	***19,049***	8,509	**10,540**
Isanti County **	39,452,913	0	59,400	***395,123***	428,618	**(33,495)**
Kalmar Township	23,560	14,136	0	***37,696***	14,239	**23,457**
Kandiyohi County	109,098	70,914	10,194	***190,206***	260,542	**(70,336)**
Le Sauk Township	26,347	9,970	3,153	***39,470***	8,903	**30,567**
Linwood Township	86,680	26,887	2,090	***115,657***	156,211	**(40,554)**
Lynden Township	18,829	10,302	0	***29,131***	24,673	**4,458**
May Township	83,595	0	0	***83,595***	40,557	**43,038**
Meeker County	63,705	39,583	0	***103,288***	0	**103,288**
Middleville Township	7,098	1,709	0	***8,807***	6,006	**2,801**
Mille Lacs County	94,488	42,810	1,560	***138,858***	190,483	**(51,625)**
Olmsted County	104,963	56,141	66,800	***227,904***	369,661	**(141,757)**
Orion Township	2,456	1,523	0	***3,979***	2,317	**1,662**
Pleasant Grove Township	6,741	4,179	0	***10,920***	4,919	**6,001**
Princeton Township	14,534	6,911	2,620	***24,065***	11,488	**12,577**
Randolph Township	126,232	12,870	1,567	***140,669***	0	**140,669**
Ravenna Township	16,291	7,341	4,988	***28,620***	360	**28,260**
Rochester Township	36,995	21,979	0	***58,974***	28,747	**30,227**
Rock Dell Township	6,825	4,472	0	***11,297***	7,235	**4,062**
Royalton Township	4,248	906	101	***5,255***	2,344	**2,911**
Salem Township	9,071	6,254	0	***15,325***	7,833	**7,492**
Stearns County	0	0	0	***0***	0	**0**
Steele County	101,860	57,879	0	***159,739***	204,941	**(45,202)**
Stillwater Township	43,605	15,272	2,486	***61,363***	65,311	**(3,948)**
Stockholm Township	6,579	1,951	0	***8,530***	6,351	**2,179**
Vermillion Township	12,222	7,298	570	***20,090***	18,803	**1,287**
Viola Township	2,102	1,240	0	***3,342***	1,898	**1,444**
Wabasha County	55,759	25,507	0	***81,266***	62,818	**18,448**
Watab Township	4,165	17,850	36,679	***58,694***	51,206	**7,488**
Waterford Township	5,661	3,309	500	***9,470***	8,755	**715**
West Lakeland Township	17,275	83,232	4,258	***104,765***	78,383	**26,382**
White Bear Township	199,409	25,914	42,950	***268,273***	208,180	**60,093**
Wright County	391,109	217,198	0	***608,307***	535,310	**72,997**

** Municipality provided updated numbers to researchers

Source: Minnesota Department of Labor and Industry as reported by municipalities



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